

itself, but it has become so popular lately that it has evolved into a category of its own, where most ROMs are based on the AOKP source code. It does provide a lot of features and customisation on top of the AOSP ROMs.

- **Cyanogen ROMs:** Most ROMs these days are built on top of customisation done by CyanogenMod, so it would be safe to categorise them as Cyanogen ROMs.

There are literally hundreds of different ROMs available for Android. And this is in no way a listing of the best; rather, just an indication of the more popular ones—and that, too, will change from time to time. Custom ROMs like these usually get very frequent updates and have many active developers working on them daily. So, while one ROM might be more popular for a period of time, modders and hackers tend to jump ship as and when new attractive features are available on competing ROMs.

CyanogenMod

CyanogenMod is usually first on the list for people new to flashing ROMs, mainly because it supports a huge number of old and new devices, and also because it has got wonderful community support in the form of dedicated forums, IRC and a Wiki. Most users flash the latest ‘nightlies’ (available every night), in order to get the absolute latest in Android development. The CyanogenMod 10.1 nightlies, for example, are available for selective devices like the Galaxy S3, and are built off the Android 4.2.1 AOSP code. These are generally considered to be less stable and may or may not work for your daily purposes, as some feature or the other might be broken, depending on which ‘nightly’ you download.



Figure 1: The Paranoid Android ROM settings page



Figure 2: The Ultima ROM default theme



Figure 3: Ultima ROM lockscreen

MIUI

The MIUI ROM, as discussed earlier, is popular primarily with those who like to customise the look of their phones with fancy lock screens and innumerable tweaks to the Android interface—which make you forget you are using Android. Though the ROM itself is not open source, it is popular among users who say it looks a bit like the iOS interface, due to the initial lack of an app drawer. This is also the very reason it is criticised, but it sure does bring some very important innovations, which are soon going to be open source, according to a recent announcement.

FoxHound

FoxHound is a Samsung ROM specific to the Galaxy S3, which is based on the latest stable Jelly Bean sources. It offers you the latest and best, along with proprietary features like pop-up play, smart stay, etc. Also, as opposed to AOSP ROMs—Bluetooth, NFC, TV-Out, Dock, etc, work flawlessly. However, its most important feature is the Aroma installer, which provides installation options like what you see while installing an operating system on your computer, where you can choose each and every component and application that you want to install on your ROM. You have the freedom to choose from different launchers, kernels, mods, keyboards, themes, etc.

ParanoidAndroid

Paranoid Android is another marvel based on CyanogenMod 10, that makes you thank the Android ecosystem for all the customisability it provides in modding your devices. This particular ROM lets you turn your phone into a mini tablet,